Panel

Tulunid or Abbasid, mid-2nd to early 4th centuries AH / 9th-early 10th centuries CE

W: 83 cm; H: 23 cm

Inv. no. 3469



Carved panel in the beveled style, with decoration in two bands: the upper band contains a Kufic inscription closely mirroring the foundation inscription of Ibn Tulun's mosque, with the sin (س) reflecting the emergence of floriated Kufic script, and ʿain (ع) in السعادة (al-saʿada, "happiness"), rendered as a three-petaled flower reminiscent of depictions of Pharaonic lotuses. Below, curvilinear pear-shaped motifs alternate with cordiforms inscribed with trefoils, recalling similar stucco and wood panels from Samarra and Cairo e.g., MIA Inv. No. 13849; MET Inv. No. 31.119.1-2. The precise symmetry and delicately incised edges reflect meticulous attention to proportion and visual balance.

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